

To help ensure that your sites are available while you redesign them, Internet Explorer 9 supports document compatibility, which refers to a set of features that allow you to direct Internet Explorer 9 to display your pages as if they were viewed by older versions of the browser.

Document compatibility controls the features that are supported by webpages and the way webpages are displayed in the browser. An extension of the compatibility mode introduced in Microsoft Internet Explorer 6, document compatibility enables you to choose the specific rendering mode that Internet Explorer uses to display your webpages.

Specifying Document Compatibility Modes

You can use document modes to control the way Internet Explorer interprets and displays your webpage. To specify a specific document mode for your webpage, use the meta element to include an “X-UA-Compatible” header in your webpage, as shown in the following example.

```
• <html>
• <head>
•   <!-- Enable IE9 Standards mode -->
•   <meta http-equiv="X-UA-Compatible" content="IE=9" >
•   <title>My webpage</title>
• </head>
• <body>
•   <p>Content goes here.</p>
• </body>
• </html>
```

If you view this webpage in Internet Explorer 9, it will be displayed in IE9 mode. The following example specifies EmulateIE7 mode.

```
• <html>
• <head>
•   <!-- Mimic Internet Explorer 7 -->
•   <meta http-equiv="X-UA-Compatible" content="IE=EmulateIE7" >
•   <title>My webpage</title>
• </head>
• <body>
•   <p>Content goes here.</p>
• </body>
• </html>
```